

Decisional Balance Worksheet

When we deliberate between two options, we often benefit from considering all “sides” in a complete way. This sheet helps guide us in thinking through the pros and cons of two options – making a change vs. not changing, doing “what we should” vs. “what we want”, or simply choosing between alternatives.

Start by specifying what each alternative is (e.g., “saying yes to the invitation” vs. “saying no to the invitation”). Then, in each of the boxes, write in all the reasons that you can think of, for or against each alternative.

This sheet can help set the stage for a dialogue between the two positions – marked in different shades below. Try voicing one position (Pro Option 1 and Con Option 2) from one chair, and the other position (Pro Option 2 and Con Option 1) from another chair, as we did in our meeting.

	Benefits/Pros	Costs/Cons
Making a change /Option A		
Not changing /Option B		